8.4.2 Example: Confidential Document Access

At ACME, all AWS access is controlled using a federation with Identity Center, which is connected to the company's corporate directory. This arrangement ensures that attributes like department are automatically synchronized and appear as principal tags on each authenticated session. ACME uses these tags in IAM policies to consistently enforce access rules across services.

When Alice uploads a document, say `arn:aws:s3:::acme-docs/report.pdf`, to the `acme-docs` S3 bucket, an AWS Lambda function deployed by ACME automatically adds two tags to the object.

- `owner-department`—copied from Alice's department principal tag
- `confidential`—set to "true" if the document is marked confidential in ACME's internal document management system

Later, Dan, who works in the same department as Alice, tries to access `arn:aws:s3:::acme-docs/report.pdf`. Since both Alice's and Dan's department values come from the same authoritative source (ACME's corporate directory via Identity Center), IAM can compare them directly.

With these tags in place, ACME can enforce the rule:

> *Permit access to confidential documents only if the requester is in the same department as the document's owner.*

The IAM policy appears as follows: